

James Fehlberg

Response to both advertised Key Capabilities

01

Demonstrated teaching competence and capacity to provide leadership that contributes to improved learning outcomes for all students.

At Ferny Grove SHS I lead development of Years 7-10 Digital Technologies curriculum and assessment, including ACARA v9 units, assessment frameworks, marking guides and exemplars. I support colleagues and early-career teachers with planning and digital pedagogy and have led whole-staff professional development on AI. The work is practical: make the curriculum clearer, make assessment expectations more consistent and give teachers resources they can actually use.

In my own classroom I use explicit teaching, scaffolding, differentiated pathways and project-based learning to make demanding content accessible across different levels of readiness. Earlier, at Kimberley College, I taught Years 7-9 across subject areas. That required me to adjust routines, instruction and support without lowering the learning expectation.

As Year 7 YLC, I would apply the same discipline at cohort level. Visible leadership and weekly parades provide opportunities to make expectations clear, recognise improvement and build Year 7 identity. I would work with the Deputy Principal, Guidance Officer and Year Level Team to look across attendance, behaviour, engagement and achievement, identify emerging concerns and coordinate support early. Students should know the expectations, know the adults supporting them and be noticed before disengagement becomes entrenched.

02

Demonstrated strong interpersonal skills and the capacity to develop and sustain productive relationships within and beyond the school community, including students, families from diverse backgrounds, and community agencies.

My approach with students is simple: keep the relationship and keep the boundary. During an exam, a student became highly escalated because they wanted computer free time instead of completing the assessment. Rather than argue across the room, I moved the conversation away from the audience, gave the student time to reset, then addressed the behaviour once they were regulated. We clarified the task, how long it was likely to take and what could happen afterwards. The student returned and completed the exam.

The same approach shapes communication with families. I begin with the facts, listen, clarify the expectation and establish the next useful action. I make patterns visible when a concern extends beyond one incident, and I also make positive contact when a student improves. I am comfortable delivering a difficult message without making the relationship adversarial.

Before teaching, I supported young people experiencing complex trauma. I used de-escalation and co-regulation, worked from case plans, maintained formal records and collaborated with families, schools, Child Safety and health professionals. That experience taught me when to act directly, when to refer and when coordinated support is the responsible response. I would bring that same judgement to student check-ins, family concerns and work with the Deputy Principal, Guidance Officer and wider support team.